New Zealand Rogaining Association (Inc.)

Minutes of 2014/15 Annual General Meeting
23 February 2015

Date/venue: Monday 23 February 2015, 6 Harrods Court, Christchurch

Present: Trevor Merrifield, Douglas Woods, Peter Squires, Emma de Lacey, Bill Kennedy, Grant Hunter, Mondo Kopua. **Apologies:** nil

1. Minutes of the 2014 AGM and matters arising
The minutes were adopted as a fair record of the meeting for the year ending February 2014. No substantive issues arising that were not covered in the current-year agenda.

2. President's Annual Report (viewable at www.rogaine.org.nz, news items)
New President Mondo Kopua

- Agreement is reached with ARA to hold the Australasian Championship 24hr rogaine in NZ on 11-12 February 2017.
- Thanked Ed Stevens, Terry Davis from Highland Events (Wanaka) for organising a successful 24 hour championship events, breaking new ground geographically and organisationally.
- Noted ongoing/increasing demand for additional leadership and organisation input into rogaining, especially in organising longer (24 and 12 hr) events and handling the increasingly technical standards of rogaining.
- Touched on options for organising rogaining nationally – see also item 6.

3. International Rogaine Federation (IRF) Representative Report (viewable at www.rogaine.org.nz, news items)
NZ IRF Rep Emma de Lacey:

- Outlined international administration/governance aspects of rogaining, including financing, event hosting, country memberships, and technical aspects of international competition.
- Thanked Nick Collins for his active contribution as a NZ rep to IRF over several years. (Nick has recently resigned from this role.)

4. Financial report (viewable at www.rogaine.org.nz, news items)
Note the financial year runs from January to December)
Treasurer Trevor Merrifield talked to the accounts:

- Net liquid assets (bank acc.) is $81,319.00, a small increase on previous year.
- Our largest financial transaction, the Heights of Winter, was cancelled through adverse ground conditions. Despite 50% refund of entry fee, by controlling costs we realised a profit of $1700, + $900 of un-cashed refund cheques still 'in the air'.
- Sponsorship of Navlight services to the Taranaki Secondary Schools rogaine has a paper value of $1900.
- Treasurer and Navlight Manager need to monitor bookings/payments of Navlight services as the booking and payments systems are not integrated. One possible outstanding payment to be checked.

5. Election of officers
Note: The current committee comprises a 'central core', plus regional representatives who in 2008 were given full committee member status, pending any future restructuring.

The following appointments were confirmed. No voting was required.

President: Mondo Kopua (PS/TM)
Secretary: *Grant Hunter (not recorded) (transitional awaiting new appointee)
Treasurer: Trevor Merrifield (not recorded)
Committee: Peter Squires (not recorded), Emma de Lacey (not recorded), Tim Farrant (DW/TM), Douglas Woods (not recorded), Nick Collins (PS/EdL)

Agreed Pete Squires to discuss with Greig Hamilton (PS/EdL) and Alastair McDowell DW/PS) their possible appointment to the committee.

(*Grant was requested to set out how he saw specialist roles being setup to support committee functions)

Regional representatives:
(subject to agreement).

Auckland –Shaun Collins
Taranaki – Annie Sanderson
Bay of Plenty/Central NI – Mark Copeland
Taupo – Darren Ashmore
Wellington –Jamie Stewart
Marlborough – Mondo Kopua
Central Otago – Ed Stevens
Otago – Bob Cunninghame, Matt Bixley

International Rogaining Federation (IRF) Representatives: Emma de Lacey (committee to decide if we should replace Nick Collins, resigned)

Technical role appointments:

Webmaster, newsletter and membership: Bill Kennedy (Bill to discuss with Wayne Millow the prospect that he take over this role on a transitional basis during the year.) (Confirmation 20/3/15 that Wayne Millow will take over the role of *Webmaster* on a transitional basis, leaving Bill with *Newsletter* and *Membership*)
Social media coordinator: Mondo Kopua
Navlight: Douglas Woods
Gear controller and assets: Douglas Woods
NZ Champs liaison: Mondo Kopua

(Mapping: not a formal role but a functional one, led by Bill Kennedy – Douglas Woods showed interest in taking a leading role here.)

6. Review national structure options for the Association and rogaining

Background: Over the last 18 mths the secretary NZRA has motivated thought/feedback on how NZRA might move to a stronger truly national framework. Views were divided across two main strands (1) greater collaboration/amalgamation with orienteering organisations nationally/regionally, (2) strengthen the NZRA framework, including setting up more action-

orientated regional/local rogaining /clubs. There tended to be a N/S Island split, northerners tending to favour (1) and the southerners (2).

Pathway 1. Greater collaboration with orienteering organisations (ONZ and/or clubs)

- Those present at the AGM saw no significant short-to-medium term scope for this. We agreed to pursue this no further, but to keep the door open for future opportunities that may arise, such as an opening or approach from orienteering organisations or leaders, or someone championing a clear process for further follow-up from within NZRA. The circumstances below do not encourage us to make a structured approach to ONZ in the short term, but we would reconsider this if shown we have misread the signals.
- We acknowledge and appreciate that many O clubs (as well as other groups, companies and individuals) organise rogaines, but organising events is not a major role of NZRA per se. (ref Rules, www.rogaine.org.nz 'about rogaining')
- Noted with thanks Nick Collin's offer of willingness to continue help establish better liaison with NZOF in the North Island.

- We base the above position on:
  - Perusal of orienteering documents, e.g., NZOF/ONZ Strategic Plan, Michael Wood's paper on rogaining 2005, which tend to support rogaining as being a recruitment ground for orienteering rather than as an equal-footing sport in its own right. (While recognising the strong overlap between rogaining and orienteering as map sports and shared participation – as does ONZ), we also respect the need for orienteering to 'focus on its knitting'.
  - Unavailability of orienteering clubs to organise and/or host or co-host a 24 hr championship event over the last 5 years. (We respect that this is the case, as above.)
  - Informal talks over the last two years with rogaining/orienteering thought leaders and influencers, and event organisers, including members of the rogaining subcommittee committee of ONZ – notably Michael Wood, Stuart Payne, Darren Ashmore.

Pathway 2. Strengthening national frameworks within NZRA

The AGM saw this as a continuing and currently unsolvable dilemma.

- A simple expression of this is the non-participation (for whatever reason) of anyone from outside Christchurch at AGMs or GM for many years, (excluding a Marlborough rep - now President - for the last two years).
- It has proven difficult to get shared views, actions and commitments across regions, most notably to engage North Islands interests. While this situation reflects a traditional strength of rogaining, i.e., a diversity of local/individual initiatives that collectively contribute an increasingly high offering of rogaining across the country - it frustrates national-level integration.
- Concluded that any 'NZRA presence' in regions must be driven by local people and initiatives, rather than through any expectation or even incentives imposed from beyond, such as by a national body with limited people resources.

- Perhaps, the message is that this is not feasible, or even necessary. Perhaps NZRA should reduce its sights and roles to core essentials, such as ensuring NZ meets its international obligations for participation in world championship events.
- We note that in 2008 the AGM agreed to give regional reps full committee member status, as an interim means to create a national persona for the organisation. While NZRA sees regional links as crucial (as a minimum, in the sense of providing local eyes and ears for rogaining), this step has achieved little extra of practical value.
- A suggestion was therefore made that over the next year, NZRA consider reverting the regional reps to non committee status, and having a more overtly (say) Canterbury or South Island core acting as the surrogate national organisation, for a reduced set of functions (such as protecting our international obligations, a clearing house for event information (website), and provision of Navlight services) and communicating with regions as issues and needs indicated. (If this was seen to have merit it could be put as a motion to the AGM in 2016.)

Pathway 3. Form regional/local rogaining clubs affiliated to NZRA

A single proposal to do this has been submitted to NZRA, for the Marlborough region, by Mondo Kopua (ref document).

- The AGM welcomed and supported this initiative as it is (1) seen in Marlborough as an effective way to support local rogaining, (2) an opportunity to test a model that might become attractive elsewhere.
- NZRA's support is expected to include startup funding (indicatively $5000-$10,000)

Factors to be resolved for this to happen include:

- Clarification of legal and other aspects of relationships between 'parent body' (i.e. NZRA) and affiliated club, bank accounts etc, including requirements to meet reporting and auditing requirements for incorporated societies.
- There is a robust regional grouping of people (versus an individual) to make this viable into the longer term.
- Agility within NZRA, including processes, to support the initiative.

7. Other business

Course planning for 2017 Australasian champs
Vetting (by an Australian rep) is to take place Dec/Jan 2015/16, so course planning needs to be completed this calendar year. We don't currently have a course planner. Identified several 'possibles' in the southern area (none of whom yet approached). Mondo or a delegate to approach them.

Federated Mountain Clubs
Agreed (Mondo Kopua was not present for this item) to action the Association's membership of FMC, a step that was approved by a general meeting back on 7 Feb 2011 and subsequently overlooked by the Sec. We will go for 'partial affiliated' club membership, nominating a membership of a minimum of five individuals (annual sub. is $12x5 = $60). (FMC encourages, but not requires, affiliated clubs to invite its own membership to join FMC as individuals at their own cost – not currently feasible for NZRA as we don't operate an annual membership process).

Computer mapping system

- Would be good to review OCAD (which we currently use) versus other mapping software, but at this stage we remain committed to OCAD, which meets our needs, and is used by many other mapsport groups.
- Need two functional licences for current level of use. Current needs are met (SI only) OK by (1) Bill's OCAD Ver. 10 Pro, (2) Douglas has purchased his own copy of OCAD Version 11 Std., which needs upgrading to Pro. (Pro version enables loading LINZ topo shapefiles into OCAD). Agreed NZRA to reimburse Douglas for this copy, upgraded to Pro.

(See appendix 1 for an explanation of mapping services provided, from Christchurch, using this service/software)

Meeting ended: 10.15pm

Next general committee meeting: TBC, but probably August

Appendix 1: Bill Kennedy's explanation of the nature of computer mapping services provided from Christchurch:

The regular customers are Ed, T'Walk (University of Canterbury TC), Stuart Payne, Bob Cunninghame, Tim Farrant, Alastair McDowell, NZRA (e.g., NZ Champs, HOW). We didn't advertise the service but it spreads by word of mouth as people see maps and enquire. There may be people in the NI preparing maps in OCAD but I have no contact with them.

Fundamentally I produce an OCAD version of the LINZ topomap. That takes 4 to 6hrs because there is some stuff that has to be done manually - it is not completely a push button process. My goal is to duplicate the LINZ map in OCAD format.

The event map is usually produced from that point by event organisers. They add/delete features at will, e.g., changes in tracks, new forest, scrub, unmarked cliffs, new ponds; also text, e.g. event name, scale, contour interval, legend, acknowledgements. (If it is an NZRA map I often do this.)

So, we do maps for Otago as well as Canterbury. But EPIC (Phil Wood and Bruce Macleod) do their own. I have produced maps for Mondo but I don't know that they have got any further than draft stage.

2015 AGM
President's Report
(Mondo Kopua)

Since being in the role of President for the past 12 months I have what I consider taken a tentative approach to the role and some of the issues and challenges that Pete Squires identified in his 2013 – 2014 report and that the NZRA group have discussed and grappled with for a few years now.

It certainly has been an interesting period where there have been a variety of issues to get myself familiar with, gain some background and learning, decisions and commitments made and a few things to still be worked through and achieve some outcomes and resolutions.

The cancellation (the first ever) of the 2014 Heights of Winter (HOW) was unfortunate but the right one given the circumstances and extreme weather (and ensuing aftermath) that the area had. The farmers were very appreciate of the sensitivity and decisions made by the organisers. It did highlight that having a Plan B (and possibly a Plan C) as part of the planning process. We are grateful that PAPO have offered us to host the HOW this year.

It was a relief to finally confirm our hosting of the 5th Australasian Championships scheduled for the weekend of 11th - 12th February 2017. We had given an assurance and commitment to the Australian Rogaine Association to host the champs but the original plans were rather protracted and drawn out. We are very fortunate that Bob Cunninghame was able to commit to hosting the Championships. We look forward to being part of the series and expect that several (most likely more) teams from NZ will participate in the other years in Australia. It would be prudent to confirm an organiser and location for 2022 by at least 2020!

The 2014 NZ Championships hosted by the Highland Events team of Ed Stevens and Terry Davis was a great success and an excellent collaboration between a 'commercial business' and a 'club' where both came away with a positive experience. I foresee that more collaboration with 'commercial event organisers', community groups, individuals and fundraisers will be an area where the NZRA and/or the Regional reps, can offer advice and assistance.

Another area requiring greater focus is organising events, notably the NZ Champs but also 12 hour ones as these tend to attract the greatest numbers particularly adventure racers, multisporters and trail runners. 12 hour rogaines are the ideal lead-in for championship level events. Although this duration is more popular and requires less land area I believe that the 24 hour format needs to continue as it is the international standard and are important to keep NZ athletes competitive in the international arena.

In Pete's (amended report) words *"The Australian Rogaining Championships, run annually by one of the State organisations in a rotation…. must meet strict criteria of organisation, vetting, and quality, and we risk losing the ability to provide this if we do not continue to have our own national championships. Organisationally, these events are much more demanding, requiring access to large tracts of land and demanding standards of course-setting, while participation is much lower. Many smaller, local events lack the formality and rigour which build the discipline for both organisers and participants to underpin championship-level rogaining. We need to find ways to improve the flows from the shorter to the longer events."*

The quality and standard of events has improved vastly over the years. With this comes the expectation of higher standards such as for mapping, course setting and control placement, risk management, food etc. I see a need, particularly for NZ Champs events, for course vetters. There are several people in the rogaine community who are capable and experienced who could vet courses. Creating a database of people and providing some support, resources and financial reimbursement will be important requirements.
I believe a key role is that of a NZ Champs Liaison/Co-ordinator. It requires someone that will be proactive with communication, providing linkages between the various contributors, establishing a team and an 'action list' with various tasks, delegated persons or leads is assigned and that regular progress reports and updates are happening in a timely manner and within specified timelines.

Although there was once an agreement with the NZOF (now ONZ) to share the hosting of the NZ Champs we currently take responsibility for these as no orienteering club has been able to commit to hosting a champs event in recent years. While the NZRA has national responsibility in the International rogaine landscape the Association is more of a networker (website, newsletters), promoter and resource provider for rogaining, rather than a prolific organiser of events. The NZRA or more specifically the core group from Christchurch (regional branch potential?) with PAPO host the annual HOW 12 rogaine on alternative years.

There are rogaines, typically 6 hours or less, being run by a diversity of event organisers, groups and individuals in many regions. These attract strong participation across a wide range of people because of their duration, requiring less training and gear etc and for organisers a smaller land area and less organisational needs. We help them where we can or where our assistance is sought.

Associated with this there still remains a mixed view of where rogaining best sits and I suspect those people that wish to have rogaining under the umbrella of Orienteering NZ (ONZ) then this is what will happen while others who consider that the NZRA, whose primary focus is rogaining, will pursue forming a regional branch of NZRA. How and what role, services and structures NZRA will then provide overall and to also support any regional branch will be the next challenge to clarify.

Regional reps and/or branches can act as a contact point for local enquires as well as being responsible for hosting, nurturing and fostering rogaines in their regions. It also allows some autonomy and at the same time can lessen the dependence and reliance of the 'core' group

of the NZRA. Smaller regional branches may attract more engagement from the local community and volunteers. Often local people are more willing to be actively involved at a local level rather than at a national level. Maybe rather optimistically by being involved at a local level some people may become interested in helping at a national level or being co-opted to assist in some way.

I've become acutely aware we require succession if the service and functions of the NZRA is to continue. How we attract people to become involved with the NZRA still remains a challenge. Rogaining, as with many other 'sports' and their committees, have been built on the volunteer system. It's my observation and experience that many /younger' people prefer to be competing than spending too much time on organising and being part of committees. While we need more volunteers I believe we should consider pursuing more engagement with commercial business' enterprises as well as considering financial reimbursement or reward for volunteers, groups, individuals and organisers. With ever increasing demands of life and work volunteers can only do so much.

Kia ora,
Mondo Kopua